Bcho NAM Player

User Manual

Standalone | Version 1.0.0

1. Overview

Bcho NAM Player is a portable standalone guitar processor for Windows, macOS and Linux. It plays Neural Amp Modeler (`.nam`) models, cabinet impulse responses (`.wav`) and a reorderable effects chain. The standalone application also owns the audio device.

2. Quick installation

Download the package for your system from the latest release and keep every file in the ZIP together.

- Windows: run `BchoNAMPlayer.exe`.
- macOS: open `BchoNAMPlayer.app`; choose Intel or Apple Silicon.
- Linux: launch the AppImage, making it executable if needed.

The initial package includes two demonstration NAM models in `Models`; no IRs are bundled. Add your own models and IRs from the centre display or drag them from the file manager. macOS packages are currently unsigned and not notarized.

3. Main panel

The head contains the **POWER** switch, input controls, tuner, amplifier controls and meters. The centre display is split into two equal zones: **NAM MODELS** and **IR FILES**. Each list shows four entries and adds scrolling when more are available.

Drag a knob vertically or horizontally to change it. Double-click any knob to restore its initial value: every control returns to 12 o’clock except **Gate**, which returns to 0 and disables the gate.

Input and amplifier controls

- **POWER**: enables or mutes the main processing path.
- **Input Gain**: level entering the NAM model.
- **Input Cali (Auto)**: compares the configured interface reference (from AUDIO SETUP) with the model's `input_level_dbu` metadata. If metadata is absent, the most likely standard NAM reference of +12 dBu is used. The small LED to the right of the switch lights green while calibration is enabled and remains off when it is disabled.
- **Gate**: professional noise gate. At 0 it is fully bypassed. Increasing it raises the threshold; the detector uses a smoothed envelope, attack, hold and release to avoid abrupt cuts.
- **Bass, Mid, Treble, Presence**: four-band EQ after the NAM preamp.
- **IR Blend**: mixes the un-convolved signal with the cabinet-IR signal.
- **Master Vol**: main level after the player chain.
- **Output Gain**: final output gain.

At default values, MAIN is neutral and sounds the same as PRE. PRE is an independent reference tap and is unaffected by player controls. The same anti-noise smoothing is applied at startup while the saved state is restored, preventing clicks.

4. Tuner

Enable **TUNER**. It always analyses the clean DI signal before gate, NAM and effects. The lights show whether the note is flat, in tune or sharp; the detected note is shown below. Standard and alternate tunings are available. For stable detection, play one isolated string at a useful level and allow noise to decay between notes.

5. NAM models and IRs

Use **BROWSE NAM** or drag a `.nam` file onto the centre list or the **PreAmp/Amp (NAM Model)** block. A folder can also be selected: if it contains several NAM files they are listed and the first is selected. If none is found, the English message **NAM file not found** is shown. A1/A2 architecture is detected automatically. The list shows four rows, adds scrolling when needed, and the up/down arrows navigate the available models; the upper arrow is disabled at the first item and the lower arrow at the last. **TONE3000** opens the online browser, downloads and loads the model with its descriptive name. Loading another NAM resets controls and switches to their defaults, with fade-out/fade-in smoothing to prevent clicks.

Use **BROWSE IR** or drag a `.wav` file onto the centre list or the **IR** block. A folder can also be selected: usable impulse-response WAVs are filtered, up to four rows are shown with scrolling, and the first item is selected automatically. If none is found, **IR not found** is shown. The arrows navigate the folder and are disabled at its limits. Clicking the already selected IR again deselects it; the IR block is then bypassed. Mono and stereo IRs are prepared for the selected audio rate without normalizing their level. IR changes are smoothed to prevent clicks.

6. Effects rack

The rack opens above the amplifier. Drag blocks to change their order and click a block to enable or bypass it. Double-click opens the advanced editor; it closes with **X**, Escape or a click outside.

The **PREAMP** and **IR** anchors define the electrical position. Before PREAMP is in front of the amp; between PREAMP and IR is the effects loop; after IR is post-cabinet. The tuner is always first and is intentionally not shown in the rack. **NAM FX** adds an optional second NAM model as an overdrive/distortion pedal. The **PreAmp/Amp**, **IR** and **NAM STOMP** blocks can also be enabled or bypassed; other effects can still process the clean DI path when those blocks are bypassed. A single click enables/bypasses a block; a double-click opens its selector/editor without accidentally changing the block state.

Each block provides three algorithms and six parameters:

Block	Types	Parameters
COMPRESSOR	Studio VCA, Optical, FET Punch	Threshold, Ratio, Attack, Release, Makeup, Mix
DELAY	Digital Studio, Tape Echo, Analog BBD	Time, Feedback, Mix, Tone, Mod, Level
CHORUS	Studio, Ensemble, Tri-Chorus	Rate, Depth, Mix, Delay, Feedback, Level
FLANGER	Analog, Through-Zero, Jet	Rate, Depth, Mix, Feedback, Manual, Level
PHASER	4 Stage, 8 Stage, 12 Stage	Rate, Depth, Mix, Feedback, Centre, Level
REVERB	Studio Room, Plate, Concert Hall	Size, Damping, Mix, Width, Freeze, Level
OCTAVER	Poly Clean, Classic Mono, Organ	Oct Down, Oct Up, Dry, Tone, Tracking, Level
PITCH SHIFTER	Studio, Low Latency, Vintage	Semitones, Mix, Window, Feedback, Fine, Level

Values are displayed with units in each block editor. Bypass, parameter and type changes are smoothed to prevent clicks; delay effects use interpolation and feedback is bounded for stable processing.

7. AUDIO SETUP — standalone only

Open **AUDIO SETUP** from the gear settings to select the audio system and driver, including ASIO on Windows; interface; active inputs and outputs; sample rate; buffer size; manufacturer control panel; and output routing.

The interface input reference selected here is used by **Input Cali**. For an interface without a documented value, use the recommended value in the application's reference table, or the +12 dBu NAM fallback when the model has no input metadata.

Available taps are **MAIN** (processed), **PRE** (NAM without player controls or effects), **DI** (clean input) and **WET** (processed post-cab branch). MAIN defaults to outputs 1/2 when enabled. The last device and routing configuration is restored on the next launch.

8. Settings, skins and updates

Click the gear icon in the right-hand corner of the speaker cabinet to open **SETTINGS**. It lets you:

- choose an installed skin for a temporary preview; it is not committed until you click **APPLY**;
- select another skin while preserving the exact positions of displays, knobs, scales and switches;
- view the installed application version;
- use **CHECK FOR UPDATES** to search manually for a newer release;
- enable or disable **CHECK ON STARTUP**, the automatic check performed when the app opens. A discreet LED shows its state, and the option lives inside Settings so it does not clutter the front panel.

The gear groups AUDIO SETUP, skin selection, version information and update options. Skin preview is temporary: moving through the selector changes the view immediately, but cancelling or closing without **APPLY** keeps the previous skin.

Update checks only report published versions; they do not alter presets, models or audio without user confirmation.

9. .bnpp presets

SAVE .BNPP creates a self-contained portable preset containing the XML state, main NAM, optional NAM pedal, IR, rack order, types, bypass states and all controls. **LOAD .BNPP** extracts its resources to a safe cache and restores the state. Audio-device settings are excluded so presets remain portable across computers and DAWs.

10. State and troubleshooting

The application restores the last NAM, IR and preset used, together with the audio device and routing. If there is no sound, check POWER, the selected device, active inputs, buffer size and INPUT VU level. If a NAM is silent, verify the file and its licence. For low latency, start with a small ASIO buffer and increase it if clicks occur. If a folder contains no matching files, check the extension and use BROWSE NAM or BROWSE IR again.